Gram Stain Instructions

Solutions:

1. Using the crystal violet staining reagent, continuously pour the reagent onto the smear of cells you have created for exactly **1 minute**.
2. Rinse the slide gently under a stream of tap water for 2 seconds.
3. Using the Gram's iodine mordant, pour the mordant for 3 seconds and **wait for 1 minute.**
4. Rinse the slide gently under a stream of tap water for 2 seconds.
5. Using the decolorizing agent, pour the agent for 3 seconds.
    a. **Wait 15 seconds** or add drop by drop to the slide until the decolorizing agent running from the slide becomes **clear**.
6. Using the counterstain (Safranin), pour the counterstain for 3 seconds and **wait 30 seconds to 1 minute.**
7. Rinse the slide gently under a stream of tap water until **no color** appears.
8. Dry the slide by blotting with a piece of absorbent paper.
9. Observe the results under oil immersion using a microscope.
    a. Pink/Red: gram-negative bacteria
    b. Blue/Purple: gram-positive bacteria